

HTC rolls out Desire Z in India

Cellphone manufacturer HTC Corporation has launched the Android-powered HTC Desire Z smartphone in India for Rs 25,590. It comes equipped with the 800 MHz Qualcomm 7230 processor, a 9.4-cm (3.7-inch) touchscreen that enables surfing the Web with a mere touch, and a dedicated QWERTY keyboard for quick texting and e-mails. The phone features the HTC Sense experience, which focuses on enriching the mobile experience, wherein the customer is placed at the centre of a whole new world of features.

It also includes a variety of keyboard shortcuts and two customisable keys for instant access to common functions without the need to open menus. Other features include HD video recording and a 5 megapixel camera with flash. Ajay Sharma, country head, HTC India, quipped, "We are upbeat about the prospects of the Desire Z and believe that Indian mobile phone users will enjoy HTC's innovations in the new Desire Z."

Google revises developer tools for Chrome

Google has updated the developer tools for its Chrome Web browser. In a blog post, company sources reported that the communication between Chrome and a Web server is now available in a new network panel.

"This gives you access to even more information at a single glance. You can sort and clear data, preserve log information upon navigation and even export network data into HAR format. All the timing information about your resource loads now comes from the network stack, not WebKit; so timing information now adequately represents raw network timing. You can see detailed timings for different phases of the loading by hovering over the log entry," Google sources explained.

New Chrome boosts speed

Google recently released a finished version of its speedy new Chrome Web browsing software for both desktop and laptop computers. Chrome 10, which represents a major milestone for the browser, offers highly competitive features including synchronisation, autofill and standards compliance—thus promising quick and responsive handling of software running in the Web browser.

"We realise that speed isn't just about pure brawn in the browser. It's also about saving time with simple interfaces," Google engineer Tim Steele said in a blog post announcing the latest Chrome release.

The release also offers improved settings for bookmarks, passwords, searches and home pages, as well as enhanced protection from websites booby-trapped by hackers with malicious code. It extends Chrome's sandboxing technology to the integrated Flash player. Sandboxing is the process of quarantining certain software components in order to block external access to systems or registry settings.

Chrome is now available free online at google.com/chrome.

Acer's Android 'Liquid Metal' launched in India

Android enthusiasts in India were in a tricky situation earlier. They either could go in for a high-end Android smartphone like the Galaxy S (that could blow a big hole in their wallet), or if they selected the sub-10k models from Samsung or Micromax, they often wished they had waited



for a better option. Well, that wait is slowly but surely getting over. Android smartphones in the range of 15–20k are slowly making inroads into India. Earlier in the year, Motorola Defy, then Samsung's stripped down version of the Galaxy S (the Galaxy S-LCD), and now the Liquid Metal from Acer have been launched in India. What is interesting about this segment is that it offers the best of both worlds—within-reach pricing and substantial specifications that make you feel you've got value for the money spent.

Liquid Metal, in particular, comes with Android 2.2 installed and Acer's own customised UI called Breeze. In addition, it offers 512 MB of RAM, 512 MB of ROM, 32 GB (extended) of storage and a 9.1-cm (3.6-inch) capacitive touchscreen display (480X800 pixels resolution) that should match the Defy's resolution.

As for the graphics and processor power, it houses a Snapdragon 800 MHz processor along with an Adreno 205 GPU for smooth graphics and operations. You could also record videos in 720p HD through its 5 MP camera that offers auto focus, image stabilisation and an LED flash.

Lastly, for entertainment it packs Dolby Mobile audio support for an immersive experience when watching videos or listening to music. The battery of 1500 mAh should be good for about 11 hours on 2G networks.